Gulbadan: Akbar’s aunt, Humayun’s sister. Lived to old age in Akbar’s empire. Made an adventurous journey to Mecca, and wrote an enjoyable account of Humayun’s reign and exile, the *Humayun-nama*

Dildar: Hindal’s mother. Persuaded a reluctant Hamida to marry Humayun, despite Hindal’s objections to the match

Sultan Begum: Askari’s wife and affectionate guardian to Akbar when he was held hostage by Askari

Mahchuchak: Humayun’s youngest wife and mother of his second son, Hakim. Fiercely protective of Hakim’s (and her own) right to rule Kabul

Hakim: Akbar’s half-brother and embattled ruler of Kabul. Was proclaimed an alternative to Akbar more than once by disenchanted warlords in Hindustan

Faridun: Hakim’s uncle. Blamed by Mughal historians for instigating Hakim’s incursions into Hindustan

Khwaja Hasan Naqshbandi: A descendant of the Naqshbandi Sufis. Among Hakim’s closest advisers. Married Hakim’s sister

Abul Qasim: Kamran’s son and Akbar’s cousin. Kept imprisoned and possibly executed by Akbar’s command

Sulaiman: Humayun’s cousin, Akbar’s uncle. Replaced Humayun as governor of Badakhshan, then became its ruler. Long hoped to rule Kabul, spent his last days as Akbar’s refugee-guest in Lahore

Haram: Sulaiman’s formidable wife, said to be the real ruler of Badakhshan

Shahrukh: Sulaiman’s grandson, Akbar’s nephew. Became a rival for Sulaiman’s throne in his teens, later joined Akbar’s court

Sharafuddin: A distant Timurid relative who came to offer his congratulations to young Akbar, remained to marry Akbar’s sister, then rebelled against him

Mirza[1] Ibrahim Husain: Best known of ‘The Mirzas’ – a clan of Timurids who were frequently guilty of insubordination, and worse, to Humayun and Akbar. Ibrahim was married to Kamran’s daughter, Gulrukh

Mirza Muhammad Husain: Mirza Ibrahim Husain’s brother. Remembered for his shock when he heard that Akbar had chased after him from Fatehpur Sikri to Ahmedabad in nine days. Was defeated in the battle that followed